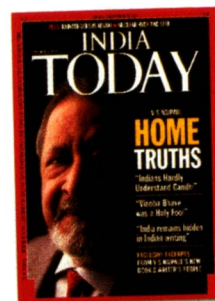
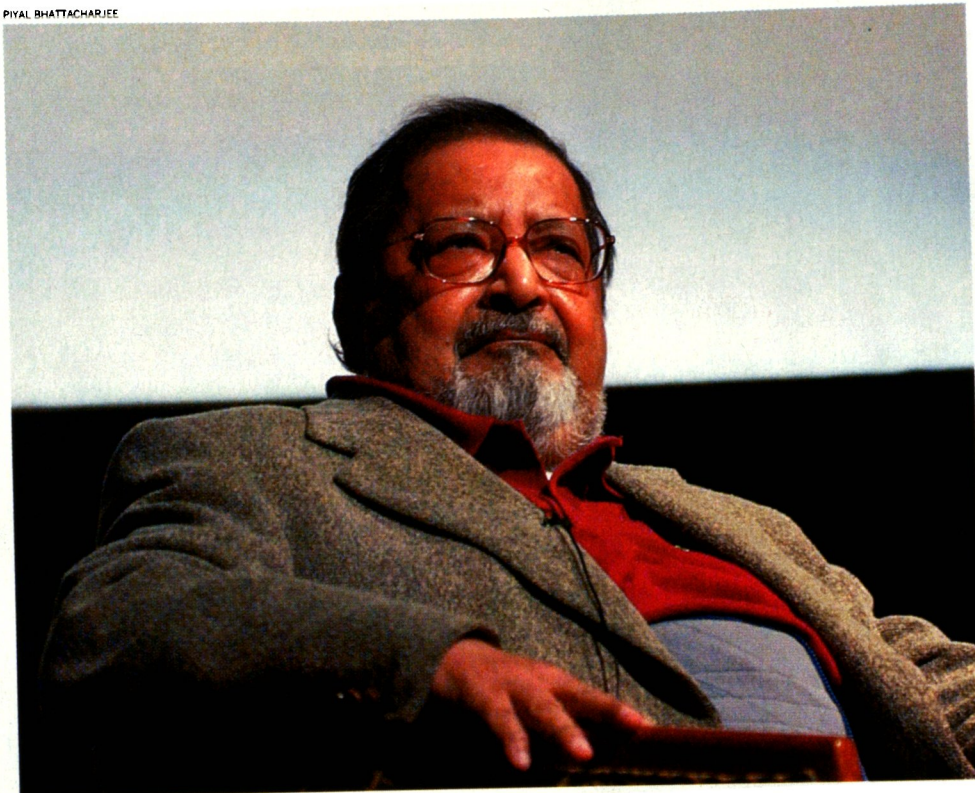


PIYAL BHATTACHARJEE



"Home Truths",
September 10, 2007
**"While Sir Vidiadhar
has a razor sharp mind
and an even sharper
tongue to go with it, he
remains something of a
cross between
Macaulay and Kipling."**

C. GOVINDAN NAIR, on e-mail

Writer's Impressions

It is common for society to be hostile towards someone who shows it the mirror ("The Provocateur", September 10). Sir Vidia is, therefore, bound to draw flak for his harsh words.
VIRENDRA KUMAR TANGRI, Dehradun

Though V.S. Naipaul has understood some facets of our civilisation quite well, his problem is that he does not read any Indian language. He is right when he says he is getting on; like most old people he has nothing new to say.
ANIRUDDHA G. KULKARNI, Pune

Naipaul's new book, and hopefully his last, seems to be the senile musings of a blatantly racist writer, who would rather wish away his brown colour and Indian origin. His innate talent for writing splendid English prose has been marred by his more than

obvious penchant for sensationalism and his insufferably abrasive descriptions of Indian icons. It defies comprehension as to why the magazine chose to raise the hackles of its readers by excerpting his outrageously presumptuous book.
NALINI VIJAYARAGHAVAN, Thiruvananthapuram

A man of profound scholarship and vision, wide global perspective and courage of conviction, Naipaul pulls no punches while expressing his views. We may not agree with him, yet we cannot fail to notice him or be impressed by him.
S.C. KAPOOR, Noida

Wrong Way of Looking

Gandhi's greatest virtue was his mastery over assembling simple tools and using them effectively to get the desired results ("Home Truths", September 10). Naipaul's observation

that he indulged in anti-modern simplicities only underlines his failure to understand this.

AMIT KUMAR, Delhi

It seems age has caught up with Naipaul. No one can, otherwise, explain his ranting and raving against the Mahatma, Vinoba Bhave and Nirad Chaudhari.
DILIP JOSHI, Pune

The excerpts from his book, *A Writer's People: Ways of Looking and Feeling*, sow seeds of doubt about the wisdom and judgement of the Noble Prize Committee.
ASHOK BHATT, on e-mail

Government in Red

Though the Left seems oblivious to the advantages of the nuclear deal, the Congress should have initiated a discussion in the Parliament to escape such a public showdown ("Winning Round One", September 10).

S. LAKSHMI, on e-mail

The Left parties' sustained tirade against the Congress-led Government seems to have less to do with the 123 Agreement and more to do with their antipathy towards the prime minister.

B.C. KUNNETH, Chennai

The country's communist parties seem to be the red light of Indian politics, whose sole intention is to stall positive developments in the country.

K.S. SAMBI, on e-mail

Instead of taking up issues like poverty, the Left is clamouring against the nuclear deal as if there is no tomorrow. It is enjoying power without any responsibility.

K. PRADEEP, Chennai

Mere Assumption

The analysis of BJP's affairs appears to be based on surmises rather than facts ("Who is the Leader?", September 10).